

# Friday, 5 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

## 00 — WEATHER

### Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

18° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

16° 11°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

16° 11°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

15° 10°

## 01 — NEWS

### Today's top stories

#### 1 **Reform UK has seen a significant boost in its coffers, thanks to some generous donations revealed in recent figures.**

New reports show the party received seven million pounds from two British crypto billionaires residing overseas earlier this year. This substantial influx has reportedly helped Reform UK solidify its fundraising lead.

POLITICS · UK

#### 2 **More people are withdrawing money early from their Lifetime ISAs, often incurring penalties, rather than using them for a first home.**

This trend suggests many are facing financial pressures, as withdrawing funds for reasons other than a first home or retirement means losing a chunk of the government bonus. It raises questions about the scheme's effectiveness for its original purpose.

FINANCE · UK

#### 3 **A talented model maker in Scotland has meticulously recreated a Glasgow landmark, Union Corner, which was sadly destroyed by fire.**

Using recycled cardboard, the artist has faithfully depicted the building's iconic dome and distinctive roof signs. It's a wonderful tribute to a much-missed piece of the city's architecture.

ARTS · SCOTLAND

## What's coming up

- 1 Fans of romantic dramas have a new genre to explore, with 'ice hockey romances' making a big splash on streaming services.**  
The Amazon Prime adaptation of Elle Kennedy's 'Off Campus' book series is proving to be a huge hit with viewers. This trend highlights the growing popularity of the 'men written by women' dynamic in TV storytelling.  
TV · ONGOING
- 2 The debate around AI's role in filmmaking is heating up, with legendary director Martin Scorsese weighing in on its potential.**  
Scorsese recently suggested AI could be 'creatively freeing,' helping directors speed up pre-production without compromising quality. This stance has sparked a significant discussion within the industry about the future of AI in cinema.  
FILM · FUTURE TECH
- 3 Model and actress Cara Delevingne is stepping into the music world, with new songs inspired by her journey to sobriety.**  
She's recently released her first two tracks, sharing that her personal experiences have deeply influenced her sound. Expect to hear more from her as she continues to explore this new artistic path.  
MUSIC · COMING SOON

## On the schedule

### 1 **Heat experts are urging FIFA to reconsider its ban on reusable water bottles at World Cup stadiums, citing potential health risks for fans.**

FIFA recently announced a late policy change, preventing fans from bringing their own bottles due to safety concerns. However, critics are calling this 'reckless' given the high temperatures often experienced at these events.

FOOTBALL · GLOBAL

### 2 **England Lioness Ella Toone is feeling stronger and wiser after recovering from a recent hip injury.**

She shared that the setback taught her a 'massive lesson,' and now she's fully prepared to get back on the pitch. Fans will be eager to see her return to top form for the national team.

FOOTBALL · ENGLAND

### 3 **Wales women's football coach Rhian Wilkinson insists her team will be ready for their World Cup qualifier despite recent travel disruptions.**

The team faced travel chaos, with Wilkinson herself spending a night in an airport. She's determined that these issues won't impact their crucial match in Montenegro on Friday.

FOOTBALL · WALES

## Quick hits

- 1 One in three of us has had a 'sleep divorce' — sleeping in a separate bed from our partner.**  
Reasons: snoring (45%), different schedules (30%), restless legs, and one bizarre 12% who say their partner 'talks to the cat in their sleep'.
- 2 The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**  
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 3 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**  
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 4 The most-Googled DIY question in Britain this year: 'how to remove silicone'.**  
Tradespeople say it's the rise of botched bathroom resealing jobs during lockdown that's still haunting people. YouTube tutorials on the topic have racked up 60 million views.
- 5 Holiday firms report a 40% spike in 'shoulder season' bookings — September and October sun trips are way up on last year.**  
Travellers blame school-holiday flight prices, unreliable summer weather, and 'August feels too crowded these days'. Spain, Greece and Portugal top the wish list.
- 6 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**  
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 7 British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**  
Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.

05 – TALKBACK

## For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

**Q** 48% of us do THIS every single day. What is it?  
**ANSWER:** STEP ON THE BATHROOM SCALES.

**Q** 63% of us have done THIS in a meeting we're meant to be paying attention to. What?  
**ANSWER:** ONLINE SHOPPING.

TALK TOPIC

- **If you won the lottery tonight, what's the FIRST thing you'd buy tomorrow?**  
Talk-back: not the dream house. Not the holiday. The first daft thing you'd buy because you finally could.
- **What's the worst job you've ever had — and how long did you last?**  
Talk-back: the war stories are usually the funniest. Bonus marks for under a fortnight.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

**FACT** **UK News.** A council in the North-West has agreed to fix a much-complained-about pothole only after a resident planted a small tree in it and the photo went viral. The pothole had been reported 17 times in a year before the tree solved it overnight.

**FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** A Devon village has voted unanimously to ban Vinted couriers from parking on its narrow high street, after a single delivery driver knocked over the same pub's hanging basket three weeks in a row.

06 – LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

**£12 million**

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

**£12 million**

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- **Sharks existed before trees. Sharks have been around for 400 million years; trees only 350 million.**
- **Bubble wrap was originally invented as wallpaper. It flopped, so they pivoted to packaging.**
- **There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on every beach on Earth.**
- **A group of flamingos is called a flamboyance.**
- **The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896 — it lasted 38 minutes.**
- **Your stomach gets a new lining every three to four days. Otherwise it would digest itself.**
- **The first message ever sent on the internet was 'LO' — they were trying to type 'LOGIN' but the system crashed.**
- **An ostrich's eye is bigger than its brain.**

## On this day

Day 156 of the year, 209 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (New Zealand); Christian feast day: Boniface; Christian feast day: Dorotheus of Gaza; Christian feast day: Dorotheus of Tyre. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

### TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Anthony Burger, American singer and pianist (died 2006)
- 1971 — Mark Wahlberg, American model, actor, producer, and rapper
- 1962 — Jeff Garlin, American actor, comedian, director, and screenwriter
- 1954 — Nancy Stafford, American model and actress
- 1995 — Ross Wilson, English table tennis player
- 1941 — Spalding Gray, American writer, actor, and monologist (died 2004)
- 1967 — Ron Livingston, American actor
- 1949 — Ken Follett, Welsh author

### THE DAY TODAY

- 1993 — Portions of the Holbeck Hall Hotel in Scarborough, North Yorkshire, UK, fall into the sea following a landslide.
- 2003 — A severe heat wave across Pakistan and India reaches its peak, as temperatures exceed 50 °C (122 °F) in the region.
- 1981 — The Morbidity and Mortality Weekly Report of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention reports that five people in Los Angeles, California, have a rare form of pneumonia seen only in patients with weakened immune systems, in what turns out to be the first recognized cases...

### TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1956 — Elvis Presley introduces his new single, "Hound Dog", on The Milton Berle Show, scandalizing the audience with his suggestive hip movements.
- 1981 — The Morbidity and Mortality Weekly Report of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention reports that five people in Los Angeles, California, have a rare form of pneumonia seen only in patients with weakened immune systems, in what turns out to be the first recognized cases...

### TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1983 — More than 100 people are killed when the Russian river cruise ship Aleksandr Suvorov collides with a girder of the Ulyanovsk Railway Bridge. The collision caused a freight train to derail, further damaging the vessel, yet the ship remained afloat and was eventually restored an...

- 2009 — A fire at a day-care center kills 49 people in Hermosillo, Mexico.
- 2002 — Space Shuttle Endeavour launches on STS-111, carrying the Expedition 5 crew to the International Space Station to replace the Expedition 4 crew. Astronaut Franklin Chang-Díaz becomes the second person to have flown on seven spaceflights.



## A peek at tomorrow

Day 157 of the year, 208 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Bessarion of Egypt; Christian feast day: Claudius of Besançon; Christian feast day: Iarlaithe mac Loga; Christian feast day: Ini Kopuria (Anglican Church of Melanesia, Church of England, Episcopal Church). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

### TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1993 — Vic Mensa, American rapper and singer
- 1947 — Robert Englund, American actor; best known for Nightmare on Elm Street
- 1977 — David Connolly, Irish footballer
- 1946 — Tony Levin, American bass player and songwriter
- 1952 — Harvey Fierstein, American actor and playwright; winner of four Tony Awards
- 1902 — Jimmie Lunceford, American saxophonist and bandleader (died 1947)
- 1960 — Steve Vai, American musician
- 1918 — Kenneth Connor, English comedy actor (died 1993)

### THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1982 — 1982 Lebanon War: The war begins as forces under Israeli Defense Minister Ariel Sharon invade southern Lebanon during Operation Peace for the Galilee, eventually reaching as far north as the capital Beirut.
- 1925 — The original Chrysler Corporation was founded by Walter Chrysler from the remains of the Maxwell Motor Company.
- 1894 — Governor Davis H. Waite orders the Colorado state militia to protect and support the miners engaged in the Cripple Creek miners' strike.

### TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — British referendum results in continued membership of the European Economic Community, with 67% of votes in favour.
- 1944 — World War II: Commencement of Operation Overlord: The Allied invasion of Normandy begins with the execution of Operation Neptune—commonly referred to as D-Day—the largest seaborne invasion in history. Nearly 160,000 Allied troops cross the English Channel with about 5,000 land...

Coming to cinemas

|           |                                                       |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| JUNE 2026 |                                                       |
| FRI 5     | Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad                 |
| FRI 12    | Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)            |
| FRI 19    | Pixar's Toy Story 5                                   |
| FRI 26    | Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life |

|           |                                                   |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------|
| JULY 2026 |                                                   |
| WED 1     | Minions & Monsters                                |
| FRI 3     | Shiver; Young Washington                          |
| FRI 10    | Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn               |
| FRI 17    | Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off |
| FRI 24    | Heads of State; Untitled DCU                      |
| FRI 31    | Spider-Man: Brand New Day                         |

|             |                                                 |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| AUGUST 2026 |                                                 |
| FRI 7       | Once Upon a Time in a Cinema                    |
| FRI 14      | Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie |
| FRI 21      | Mutiny; The Bride!                              |
| FRI 28      | Crime 101; Outcome                              |

|                          |                       |
|--------------------------|-----------------------|
| SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW |                       |
| FRI 4                    | Conjuring: Last Rites |
| FRI 11                   | Resident Evil reboot  |
| FRI 18                   | The Black Phone 2     |
| FRI 25                   | Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)   |

|                        |                                         |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW |                                         |
| FRI 16                 | Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller |
| FRI 23                 | Frankenstein (del Toro)                 |

## On the sporting calendar

| JUNE 2026       |                                             | JULY 2026      |                                        |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------|
| 11 JUN – 19 JUL | FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)      | 4–26 JUL       | Tour de France (Cycling)               |
| 11–14 JUN       | World Cup of Darts                          | SUN 5          | British Grand Prix, Silverstone        |
| 12 JUN – 5 JUL  | ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales) | 16–19 JUL      | The Open Championship (Golf)           |
| 18–21 JUN       | U.S. Open (Golf)                            | 18–26 JUL      | World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool       |
| 29 JUN – 12 JUL | Wimbledon                                   | 23 JUL – 2 AUG | Commonwealth Games, Glasgow            |
|                 |                                             | AUGUST 2026    |                                        |
|                 |                                             | W/C 10         | Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)   |
|                 |                                             | SAT 15         | Premier League season begins (2026/27) |
|                 |                                             | 22–23          | Belgian Grand Prix (F1)                |